

Scholia and the Scholarly Tradition of Pindar Commentary

eul_aid: ppu

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Ἀττικίζουσα [Atticizing](#)
Domain: Λεξικογραφία [Lexicography](#)
Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

The Pindar Commentary refers not to a single person but to a body of ancient scholarly work produced to explain the complex poetry of Pindar, a major Greek lyric poet of the 5th century BCE. These commentaries were written by various grammarians and scholars, primarily during the Hellenistic and Roman periods.

A specific collection known as the Pindarikē hypomnēsis is dated to the 2nd century CE, a time of revived interest in classical Greek literature known as the Second Sophistic. Scholars of this era wrote in an Atticizing prose style to elucidate Pindar's works for students and educated readers. The commentaries served as essential guides, providing explanations of Pindar's dense language, obscure myths, historical references, and poetic meters. They were often organized according to the traditional collections of Pindar's odes. The listed count of seven works likely refers to sections of a commentary covering a specific group of these odes, rather than separate books by one author.

These ancient notes are of great historical importance. While the original full commentaries are lost, their content was preserved as marginal notes, or scholia, in medieval manuscripts of Pindar's poetry. These scholia contain fragments of earlier scholarship, including work by famous Alexandrian grammarians. This tradition is a critical link in preserving classical literature, offering invaluable insights that shape our understanding of Pindar's work today.

Works (7)

- [Κεφάλαια εἰς τὴν Προοίμιον Σχολίων εἰς Πινδάρου](#) · [Chapters to the Preface of Scholia-Pindar's Poems](#) · 6 passages
- [Σχόλια καὶ Γλῶσσαι εἰς Ὀλυμπιακὰ καὶ Πυθιακὰ](#) · [Scholia and Glosses-Olympia and Pythia](#) · 2014 passages
- [Σχόλια εἰς Πίνδαρον Ἰσθμιακὰ](#) · [Scholia on Pindar \(Olympians, Pythians, Isthmians\)](#) · 4116 passages
- [Σχόλια εἰς Πίνδαρον](#) · [Scholia on Pindar \(Selections/Glosses\)](#) · 667 passages
- [Σχόλια εἰς Νεμεακὰ καὶ Ἰσθμιακὰ](#) · [Scholia-Nemean and Isthmian Odes](#) · 893 passages
- [Σχόλια εἰς Παιᾶνας](#) · [Scholia-Paeans](#) · 95 passages
- [Σχόλια εἰς Πυθιακὰ Ὀιδὰς Ε' -Ζ'](#) · [Scholia-Pythian Odes V-VII](#) · 153 passages